

YOUR GAME · SUN, SEP 6 · 1930 ET · NBC

Wisconsin (8%) at #4 Notre Dame (92%) Notre Dame -20.5

Win and Notre Dame's playoff odds are 77.1%; lose and they're 63.3%. A 13.8-point swing, the biggest thing on this page by far.

Ranked by leverage · how much the result moves Notre Dame's playoff odds, discounted by how unlikely the swing is · the boxed team is the one to pull for

- 1

Mon, Sep 7 · 1930 ET · ESPN

#19 SMU (52%) at Florida State (48%) SMU -3 · O/U 53.5

A SMU win happens 52% of the time and is worth 0.26 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.9% vs 74.6%)
Mostly because SMU is on Notre Dame's schedule (wk 12); the better their record, the more your result against them counts (proj. 8 wins); also this affects who wins the ACC, and a champion takes an auto-bid instead of an at-large spot.

Leverage 54 Impact 41
- 2

Sun, Sep 6 · 1600 ET · NBC

Washington State (9%) at #17 Washington (91%) Washington -23.5 · O/U 51.5

A Wash St win happens 9% of the time and is worth 0.39 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.7%)
Because Washington is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 13% of seasons).

Leverage 26 Impact 62
- 3

Fri, Sep 4 · 2100 ET · FOX

Fresno State (10%) at #14 USC (90%) USC -22.5 · O/U 51.5

A Fresno St win happens 10% of the time and is worth 0.32 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.7%)
Because USC is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 14% of seasons).

Leverage 24 Impact 51
- 4

Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · FOX

Boston College (32%) at Cincinnati (68%) Cincinnati -7.5 · O/U 49.5

A Boston Col win happens 32% of the time and is worth 0.12 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.7% vs 74.6%)
Mostly because Boston College is on Notre Dame's schedule (wk 11); the better their record, the more your result against them counts; also Cincinnati is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you.

Leverage 22 Impact 19
- 5

Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · FS1

Marshall (5%) at #18 Penn State (95%) Penn State -23.5 · O/U 52.5

A Marshall win happens 5% of the time and is worth 0.36 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.7%)
Because Penn State is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 16% of seasons).

Leverage 15 Impact 57
- 6

Sat, Sep 5 · 1200 ET · ABC

East Carolina (9%) at #13 Alabama (91%) Alabama -28.5 · O/U 52.5

A ECU win happens 9% of the time and is worth 0.22 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.9% vs 74.7%)
Because Alabama is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).

Leverage 15 Impact 35
- 7

Fri, Sep 4 · 2000 ET · FS1

Toledo (21%) at Michigan State (79%) Michigan State -10 · O/U 46.5

A Mich St win happens 79% of the time and is worth 0.11 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.7% vs 74.6%)
Mostly because Michigan State is on Notre Dame's schedule (wk 3); the better their record, the more your result against them counts; also Toledo is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you.

Leverage 15 Impact 17
- 8

Sat, Sep 5 · 1230 ET · CW

Miami (OH) (23%) at Pittsburgh (77%) Pittsburgh -16.5 · O/U 47.5

A Miami (OH) win happens 23% of the time and is worth 0.10 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.8% vs 74.7%)
Because Pittsburgh is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you.

Leverage 15 Impact 16
- 9

Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · ESPN

Texas State (5%) at #5 Texas (95%) Texas -29.5 · O/U 59.5

A Texas St win happens 5% of the time and is worth 0.33 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.7%)
Because Texas is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 16% of seasons).

Leverage 13 Impact 52
- 10

Sat, Sep 5 · 1930 ET · NBC

Western Michigan (6%) at #16 Michigan (94%) Michigan -27.5 · O/U 49.5

A W Michigan win happens 6% of the time and is worth 0.25 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.9% vs 74.7%)
Because Michigan is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).

Leverage 12 Impact 40

Leverage and impact are scaled 0–100 against the biggest remaining game that doesn't involve Notre Dame. Win chances from SP+ with home advantage; every number from 10,000 simulated seasons with each game flipped one at a time.